

PART FIVE

 Top Tips





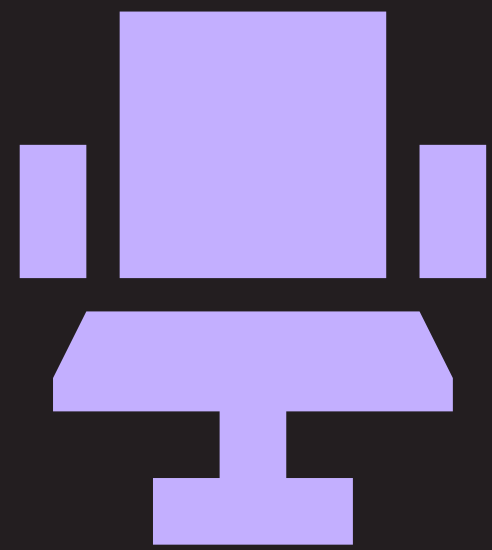
be a human

Build a connection with your clients and **humanise yourself**. Make them feel smart, make them feel like they came up with ideas. **Have a story** behind your decisions. **Be vulnerable, you're in this together** with your clients.



avoid conflict

Blame process, not yourself. Be firm when saying no, but try and make it a 'yes but'. Frame your noes as opportunities. **Avoid conflict, especially early.** Usually you can find an agreement, or be vulnerable and make them understand why something might not be so simple.



create a cushion

Pad your timelines upfront, and adjust later to accommodate. Make it clear you are flexible. Emphasise the great services we provide for our clients, our malleability and how custom deployments can be. **UNDER PROMISE, OVER DELIVER.**



make scope creep a win

Don't say 'it's out of scope'. Say, 'let's explore it'. Read back scope status regularly to manage scope creep gently. **Accept a few small changes to avoid the big ones.** Use the scope run through meetings effectively.



perception matters

Make the team seem bigger than it is, especially for large clients. **Bring in engineers and Agent Designers and emphasise them.** Call them leads and talk about their teams. Build credibility with out expertise. On-sites are incredibly valuable, people are much nicer and more reasonable in person. **Travel.**

